

ELIZABETH HUFFAKER

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APPOINTMENTS

University of Florida, College of Education

Assistant Professor of Educational Leadership and Policy 2025–
Faculty Affiliate, UF Education Policy Research Center

Stanford University, Graduate School of Education

Faculty Affiliate, Systems Change for Advancing Learning and Equity (SCALE) 2025–
Postdoctoral Fellow, National Student Support Accelerator 2024–2025

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics of Education & Education Policy 2024
Stanford University

Certificate in Quantitative Research in Education

M.A. Economics 2022
Stanford University

M.A. Education Policy 2019
Teachers College, Columbia University

Specialization in Data Analysis and Research Methods

B.A. Mathematical Economic Analysis & Philosophy 2013
Rice University

RESEARCH AREAS

Economics of Education · Education Policy Analysis · Causal Inference · Randomized Controlled Trials
Math Education Policy · Tutoring · Research–Practice Partnerships

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Huffaker, E., Robinson, C., Bardelli, E., White, S., & Loeb, S. (forthcoming). When interventions don't move the needle: Insights from null results in education research. *American Educational Research Journal*. (EdWorkingPaper: 25-1295). <https://doi.org/10.26300/58dd-6d02>

*Dee, T. S., & **Huffaker, E.** (2026). Accelerating opportunity: The effects of instructionally supported detracking. *American Educational Research Journal*, 63(2), 307–350. <https://doi.org/10.3102/00028312251408539>

Huffaker, E., Novicoff, S., & Dee, T. S. (2025). Ahead of the game? Course-taking patterns under a math pathways reform. *Educational Researcher*. <https://doi.org/10.3102/0013189X241309642>

*Denotes joint lead authorship, alphabetical order.

Cohodes, S. R., Ho, H., **Huffaker, E.**, & Robles, S. C. (2024). Residential vs. online? Experimental evidence on diversifying the STEM pipeline. *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 114, 507–511.
<https://doi.org/10.1257/pandp.20241016>

Dee, T. S., **Huffaker, E.**, Phillips, C., & Sagara, E. (2023). The revealed preferences for school reopening: Evidence from public-school disenrollment. *American Educational Research Journal*, 60(5), 916–940.
<https://doi.org/10.3102/00028312221140029>

Under Review

Huffaker, E., Lee, M., Zhou, H., Robinson, C., & Loeb, S. Beyond the one-teacher model: Experimental evidence on using embedded paraprofessionals as personalized instructors. (EdWorkingPaper: 25-1326). Annenberg Institute at Brown University. <https://doi.org/10.26300/pzy2-wr51>

Wentworth, L., Arce-Trigatti, P., Borko, H., Carlson, C., Dee, T., Dye, V., Firestone, A., Ganschow, J., Gerstein, A., **Huffaker, E.**, Mercado-Garcia, D., Mafi, G., Novicoff, S., Owen, L., Rice, J., Sewell, J., & Wright, K. A research-practice-policy systematic review method involving networked partnerships: The example of secondary mathematics course sequences.

Submitted

Huffaker, E., Levin Markel, B., Robinson, C. D., & Loeb, S. Tutor traits and student achievement: Evidence from a randomized experiment. (EdWorkingPaper: 26-1595). Annenberg Institute at Brown University. <https://doi.org/10.26300/jgzm-qp55>

Research & Policy Reports

Huffaker, E., Burns, D., Carver-Thomas, D., Darling-Hammond, L., Dykeman, K., Gallagher, H. A., Gomez, D. M., Haderlein, S., Jackson, J., Kini, T., Kurlaender, M., Larson, B., Leung-Gagné, M., Li, Y., Loeb, S., Patrick, S. K., Polikoff, M. S., Price, H., Reardon, S., Reed, S., Smith, T. M., Sorensen, L., Tan, T. S., & Towne, L. (2026). Mathematics in California: Gaps, capacity, and implementation. *Getting Down to Facts III*. Stanford SCALE.

Huffaker, E. (2026). Adoption windows and reform: California’s math pathways in the post-Common Core era. *Getting Down to Facts III*. Stanford SCALE.

Huffaker, E. (2025). Evidence-based practices for Algebra I access, placement, and success. *EdResearch for Action*.

RESEARCH FUNDING

University of Florida Lastinger Center for Learning & College of Education Office of Educational Research. Lastinger Center Research Catalyst Award. “Workforce Development Research Plan.” Principal Investigator.	2026 \$50,000
Learning Engineering Virtual Institute. “It Takes a Village (Plus AI): A Randomized Controlled Trial of Hybrid Human-AI Math Tutoring at Scale.” Co-PI with D. Thomas (PI).	2026–2028 \$500,000 (Subaward: \$18,000)
Gates Foundation. “Achievement Impacts of Algebra I Timing and Enrollment Policies.” Co-PI with G. Zuo (PI).	2025–2030 \$2,300,000 (Subaward: \$250,000)

University of Florida Early Childhood Policy Research Seed Funding. “Step-by-Step: Towards Data-Driven Numeracy Tutoring for Early Grade Learners.” Principal Investigator.	2025–2026 \$6,000
J-PAL North America Social Policy Research Initiative. “A Parent-Child Math Engagement Program to Enhance Learning and Decrease Math Anxiety.” Co-PI with K. Cortes (PI).	2025–2026 \$98,123

Grants Not Funded

Spencer Foundation, Small Research Grants on Education. “Access Reimagined: Opportunity and Outcomes for Students with Disabili- ties Following a Graduation Pathways Reform.” Principal Investiga- tor. Top 54 of ~1,300 applications (~4%).	2026 Finalist
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HONORS & FELLOWSHIPS

EdResearch for Action Writers Fellowship, 2025 Cohort Annenberg Institute at Brown University	2025
Community Impact Award (co-recipient, Stanford–Sequoia K-12 Collaborative) Stanford University	2025
Research-Practice Partnership Award (co-recipient, Stanford–Sequoia K-12 Collaborative) California Educational Research Association	2023
Emerging Education Policy Scholar (EEPS), 2023 Cohort Thomas B. Fordham Institute & American Enterprise Institute	2023
Anne T. and Robert M. Bass Fellow Stanford Graduate Fellowship in Science and Engineering, Stanford University	2021–2024
Education Policy Academy Scholar American Enterprise Institute [Cancelled due to the COVID-19 pandemic]	2020
Institute of Education Sciences Predoctoral Training Fellowship Stanford Interdisciplinary Doctoral Training Program in Quantitative Education Policy Analysis, Stanford University	2019–2021
TC Scholarship Teachers College, Columbia University	2017–2018

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA.	(forthcoming)
Huffaker, E. , Lee, M., Zhou, H., Robinson, C., & Loeb, S. “Beyond the One-Teacher Model: Experi- mental Evidence on Using Embedded Paraprofessionals as Personalized Instructors.”	
The Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness 2026 Conference, Baltimore, MD.	(forthcoming)

- Huffaker, E., & Cortes, K.** “A Parent-Child Math Engagement Program to Enhance Learning and Decrease Math Anxiety: Results from a Randomized Controlled Trial.”
American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA. 2026
Huffaker, E., & Malhotra, K. P. Roundtable: “Access Reimagined: Disability, Opportunity, and Outcomes for Students with Disabilities under a Graduation Pathway Reform.”
- Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Chicago, IL. 2026
Huffaker, E., & Cortes, K. “A Parent-Child Math Engagement Program to Enhance Learning and Decrease Math Anxiety: Results from a Randomized Controlled Trial.”
- California Mathematics Council–North Annual Conference, Asilomar, CA. 2025
Wentworth, L., Dee, T., Dye, V., **Huffaker, E., & Krugman, D.** “Four Districts Use Research to Increase Course Accessibility.”
- Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Washington, D.C. 2025
Huffaker, E., Robinson, C., & Loeb, S. “The Impact of Tutor–Student Demographic Matching on Students’ Outcomes.”
- Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Baltimore, MD. 2024
Huffaker, E. “Bridge or Barrier: A Regression Discontinuity Comparison of Math Remediation.”
- American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA. 2024
Huffaker, E. Roundtable: “Corequisite vs. Prerequisite Math Remediation in a K–12 Context.”
- American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL. 2023
Dee, T. S., & **Huffaker, E.** “Accelerating Opportunity: Evidence from the Algebra Initiative.”
- Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Denver, CO. 2023
Huffaker, E. “Integrated Math in US High Schools: Evidence on Course-Taking Effects in California.”
- 7th IZA Workshop on the Economics of Education, Virtual. 2022
Dee, T. S., & **Huffaker, E.** “Building Equitable Math Pathways: Evidence from the Algebra Initiative.”
- The Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness 2022 Conference, Washington, D.C. 2022
Huffaker, E. “Integrated Math in US High Schools: Evidence on Course-Taking Effects in California.”
- Association for Education Finance and Policy Annual Conference, Denver, CO. 2022
Dee, T. S., & **Huffaker, E.** “Building Equitable Math Pathways: Evidence from the Algebra Initiative.”

INVITED TALKS & PANELS

- PACE-SCALE Getting Down to Facts III 2026 Conference, Sacramento, CA. 2026
Panelist, “Education Workforce and Instructional Improvement.”
- Leading Now Monthly Briefing, Online Workshop. 2026
Co-Presenter, “Algebra I: Research and Steps to Support Student Success.”
- AERA Tracking/Detracking SIG, Online Panel. 2026
Panelist, “Detracking Mathematics to Close Opportunity Gaps: Insights from the Accelerating Opportunity Study.”
- The Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness 2025 Conference, Chicago, IL. 2025
Panelist, “Policy Talk: Collaborative Brief Writing for Actionable Research: The Role of Researchers and Practitioners.”

National Student Support Accelerator Conference, Stanford, CA.	2025
Panelist, “Strategies for Embedding Tutoring.”	
Association for Education Finance and Policy Conference, Washington, D.C.	2025
Panelist, “Policy Talk: Collaborative Brief Writing for Actionable Research: The Role of Researchers and Practitioners.”	
Annenberg Seminar on Educational Policy, Brown University.	2025
Presenter, “Strategies for Promoting Secondary Math Achievement and Equitable Access to Algebra I.”	
Rhode Island School Superintendents Association–Annenberg Institute Workshop Series.	2025
Co-Presenter, “Structural Algebra Policies.”	
Los Angeles Education Research Institute Research and Policy Seminar, Virtual.	2024
Co-Presenter, “Accelerating Opportunity: The Effects of an Instructional Support Algebra I Initiative.”	
Stanford Graduate Studies Institute, Virtual.	2024
Panelist, “Stanford Sequoia K-12 Research Collaborative: Impact Scholarship Spotlight.”	
Annual Circle Night Lecture, Stanford University.	2023
Co-Presenter, “Understanding the Pandemic Exodus from Public Schools.”	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Florida, College of Education	Gainesville, FL
Instructor: Applied Education Policy Research (Ed.D.)	Fall 2026
Instructor: Quantitative Methods in Educational Administration (Ed.D.)	Spring & Summer 2026
Instructor: Quantitative Inquiry in Education Policy (Ph.D.)	Fall 2025
Stanford University, Graduate School of Education	Stanford, CA
Teaching Assistant: Quasi-Experimental Research Design and Analysis	2021–2023
Syllabus Consultant: Quasi-Experimental Research Design and Analysis	2021
Instructor: “GSE Math Camp” for incoming doctoral students	2020–2022
Spring Branch Independent School District	Houston, TX
Instructional Coach: Spring Woods High School Math Department	2016–2017
Teacher: AP Calculus BC, AP Calculus AB, Pre-Calculus, Algebra II	2013–2017

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Dissertation: “Advancing Equity & Achievement: Four Papers on the Role of Math Reform in Shaping Students’ High School Trajectories” 2024

Committee: T. S. Dee (advisor), E. Bettinger, S. R. Cohodes, S. Loeb, & J. Osuna

Supported by the Stanford–Sequoia K-12 Research Collaborative and the Stanford–SFUSD Partnership

National Student Support Accelerator, Stanford University 2023–2024
Doctoral Student Researcher

John W. Gardner Center for Youth and their Communities, Stanford University 2021–2022
Doctoral Student Researcher

Center for Education Policy Analysis, Stanford University 2019–2021
Doctoral Student Researcher
Research supported by funding from the Institute of Education Sciences, Grant R305B140009.

Department of Education Policy and Social Analysis, Teachers College, Columbia University 2018–2023
Graduate Research Assistant
Principal Investigator: Dr. Sarah R. Cohodes

Survey Research Initiative at Teachers College, Columbia University 2018–2019
Research Associate
Principal Investigator: Dr. Priscilla Wohlstetter

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Invited Reviewer

Journals: Educational Researcher · Journal of Policy Analysis and Management · Cogent Education · Frontiers in Education

Conferences: American Educational Research Association (Division L, Educational Policies and Politics; SIG–Access, Detracking, and Tracking) · Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE)

Grants: European Research Council

University of Florida

Departmental Representative, College of Education Faculty Policy Council 2026–

Stanford University Mentoring & Committees

Student Representative, Social Sciences, Humanities, and Interdisciplinary Policy Studies (SHIPS) Faculty Committee 2023–2024

Mentor, Stanford GSE Peer Mentorship Program 2022–2023

Student Representative, Education Colloquium Series 2022

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS & AFFILIATIONS

Invited Researcher, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) North America (2026–)
Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP)

American Educational Research Association (AERA)
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)
Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE)

SELECTED PUBLIC WRITING & PRESS COVERAGE

Public Writing

Huffaker, E., & Claiborne, C. (May 23, 2025). From algebra to calculus (or stats!): Connecting the math pipeline. *Flypaper*.

Press Coverage

The New York Times · *National Public Radio* · *The Economist* · *The Daily Mail* · *Education Week* · *The 74 Million* · *ChalkBeat* · *The Hechinger Report* · *EdSource* · *The Marshall Memo* · *EduProgress* · *Flypaper* · *Edutopia* · *San Francisco Chronicle* · *The San Francisco Standard* · *The Frisc*